

Islaa7 Complete Business Report

Private on-demand repair marketplace for Abu Dhabi with a long-term circular economy vision

Executive summary

Islaa7 is a private on-demand repair marketplace that connects residents with vetted repair shops and technicians. The business is designed to make repair easier than replacement, starting in Abu Dhabi and expanding later if the pilot succeeds. Its core value is convenience, trust, and reliable access to repair services, with sustainability as an important long-term outcome.

The problem

The UAE is one of the world's biggest waste generators. Abu Dhabi's per capita municipal waste generation has been reported at around 1.8 kg per person per day, and UAE-wide waste levels remain significant. Studies also show that a 1 percent increase in median income is associated with an additional 1.86 kg of household waste per person per year, which means waste tends to rise as households become wealthier unless there is a structural alternative like Islaa7. A repair-first platform matters because the current system still makes it easier to replace than to repair.

What Islaa7 solves

- No trustworthy way to find repair professionals.
- Unclear pricing creates hesitation to repair.
- No incentive system for sustainable behaviour.
- Skilled tradespeople lack digital reach.

Islaa7 is built to solve these problems by giving people one place to request repairs and giving shops a new way to reach customers.

The solution

A user selects a category in the app, submits the repair request, and the platform matches the request to a suitable business or technician. If no one accepts quickly, the

team steps in and assigns a shop manually. The app is designed to feel simple and fast, almost like ordering another service, while still keeping the repair process trusted and controlled.

How the business works

The first launch is planned as a private institution, not a government service. Islaa7 takes a 10 percent commission per repair. Payment starts as cash, with card payment available if the shop supports it. At the end of the month, the platform counts the jobs that came through Islaa7 and businesses settle the commission owed. Each repair also receives a 5-star rating, which helps shape future recommendations.

Quality control and trust

Trust is central to the model. Shops are prioritized based on service quality, category fit, and reliability. If a repair fails, the issue is investigated, the shop is given a chance to fix it, and repeated problems reduce the shop's priority or remove it from the app. The 24 to 48 hour follow-up window is a core trust feature because it gives users confidence that the platform stands behind the service.

Waste reduction impact

Abu Dhabi has reported major waste volumes in recent years, including 3.45 million tonnes of waste converted into environmentally friendly products in 2022, and Tadweer Group reported managing 8.864 million tonnes of waste in 2024 with a 34 percent diversion rate. Islaa7 does not need to solve all of that on its own to matter. Even a modest repair shift in one community can keep electronics and bulky household items in use longer, reduce avoidable waste, and support circular economy habits.

Target market

The first launch area is Al Raha Beach and nearby Abu Dhabi communities. The early target customer is someone who wants a quick repair without wasting time searching for a technician, especially for items that are inconvenient to move or difficult to diagnose. The platform is also valuable for repair shops because it gives them more visibility and more qualified demand.

Operating model

The platform is built to work like a matching layer between customer and shop. Users choose a category in the app, and the platform routes the request to appropriate businesses. A small number of shops is enough for the pilot as long as the service is reliable and the response times are strong. The long-term goal is to make matching faster and more automated as volume grows.

Revenue model

Islaa7 earns revenue by taking a 10 percent commission on each repair. This is simple, easy to explain, and easy to track, but it only becomes meaningful when enough jobs flow through the system. That is why the business must start lean and grow step by step.

Market plan

Phase 1: Local proof in Al Raha Beach and nearby communities, with a narrow category focus and a small shop network.

Phase 2: Expansion into more Abu Dhabi communities if the pilot proves that users book, shops accept, and service quality stays strong.

Phase 3: Widening into more categories, more automation, and possible native mobile apps.

Phase 4: Explore B2B partnerships with larger retailers if the platform becomes established.

Phase 5: Move toward broader regional expansion if the business proves repeatable and profitable.

Financial plan

The business is intentionally lean because the app is already built and the domain is already purchased. The main monthly costs are now infrastructure, maintenance, marketing, and support. The lean monthly operating range can stay low if the team handles most work themselves, while the fuller operating range rises if the business outsources more and runs paid ads consistently. At a 10 percent commission, the platform needs enough monthly completed repairs to cover those costs and then grow beyond break-even.

1 to 2 year plan

The first stage is hyper-local validation. The goal is to prove the model in one area, with a small number of repair partners and one or two initial categories. Success in this stage means people actually use the app, shops accept jobs, and the service feels easier than the old way of searching manually. If that works, the business can expand to more communities in Abu Dhabi.

3 to 5 year plan

If the pilot works, Islaa7 can expand to more categories, more communities, and a more advanced matching system. This stage can include stronger analytics, better shop tools, and possibly native mobile apps. The business can also explore partnerships with larger retailers and service providers if the platform becomes established.

Long-term vision

In the long run, Islaa7 can become more than a repair booking platform. It can become a repair infrastructure layer for the UAE and later other regional markets. The strongest long-term outcome is that Islaa7 becomes the easiest way for people to repair rather than replace, while also contributing to waste reduction and a more circular economy.

Main risks

The main risks are weak matching, inconsistent shop quality, manual payment collection friction, and expanding too early. The business can also fail if the user experience is not fast enough to feel better than calling around manually. For that reason, operational discipline is more important than ambitious branding in the early phase.

Conclusion

Islaa7 is a strong idea because it solves a real problem in a way that fits the UAE's digital habits. The opportunity is not just sustainability, but convenience, trust, and local service quality. If the team stays disciplined, proves the pilot, and grows carefully, Islaa7 can become a meaningful local platform and possibly a broader regional repair network.

Quick facts

Area	Plan
Launch market	Al Raha Beach and nearby Abu Dhabi communities
First category	Electronics first, then other repair categories
Revenue	10 percent commission per repair
Trust system	5-star rating per repair and tiered shop priority
Guarantee	24 to 48 hour follow-up protection
Timeline	1 to 2 years local proof, 3 to 5 years expansion